

HOUSE BILL 1298

By Powell

AN ACT to amend Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 4 and Title 49, Chapter 7, relative to the establishment of a higher education scholarship program for students who demonstrate artistic excellence in spoken word poetry.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Title 49, Chapter 4, Part 7, is amended by adding the following as a new section:

(a) This section is known and may be cited as the "Speak UP, Tennessee Scholarship Act."

(b) The Tennessee student assistance corporation (TSAC) shall promulgate rules, in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5, to establish a program that provides scholarships for students in grade twelve (12) and students enrolled in public institutions of higher education in this state who demonstrate artistic excellence in spoken word poetry through a competitive, performance-based selection process and who wish to pursue higher education to further develop their literary and performance skills. The scholarships may be funded by appropriations from the general assembly, grants, and private donations.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect upon becoming a law, the public welfare requiring it, and applies to the 2025-2026 school year and subsequent school years.